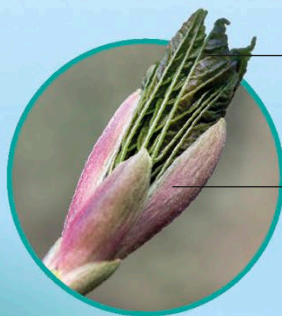




**Bursting buds** ▶ Leaves and new stems sprout from buds that protect the soft, delicate tissue from winter frosts. The new growth makes the bud burst open.



*Leaf is tightly folded inside the bud but soon bursts out.*

*Bud scales are tough and weatherproof.*

**Norway maple**

**Spring**

As the weather gets warmer in spring, leaves begin to sprout from buds on the branches. The green leaves use sunlight to make food for the tree to grow and produce flowers.

**Summer**

Long days of sunlight allow the tree to make lots of food, and the tree is thick with leaves and yellow flowers, which are cross-pollinated primarily by bees. When fertilized, the flowers will become fruits and seeds will form.

**Through the seasons**

A deciduous tree, such as this Norway maple, has a cycle of growth that follows the seasons.

# What is a tree?

Of all the plants, trees are the biggest and live the longest. Instead of green stems, they have woody trunks, which usually divide into many branches. The woody tissue is very strong, allowing some trees to grow to incredible heights of 330 ft (100 m) or more. A network of roots anchors the tree to the ground and draws up water and nutrients from the soil.